Part A – Case Study:

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud (Real Incident)

UPI fraud is a cybercrime where attackers trick users into approving payments or sharing sensitive banking details. A real incident reported in *The Times of India* involved a 21-year-old student in Bhopal who lost ₹97,000 while trying to contact his bank's customer support.

The victim searched online for a helpline number but reached a fake one. The fraudster asked him to share his screen on a call and follow certain steps. During this process, the scammer gained access to his phone and transferred money from his account without his consent.

Such scams usually target students, elderly people, and those unfamiliar with digital security. The consequences include financial loss and misuse of personal data. This case shows the importance of verifying official sources and never sharing OTPs, PINs, or screen access with unknown individuals.

Part B – Prevention Checklist:

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

- Create strong passwords using a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols, and use a different password for each account.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on important accounts like email, social media, and banking apps.
- Always verify the sender before clicking on links in emails or messages—avoid unknown or suspicious links.
- Download apps only from trusted sources like official app stores.
- Avoid logging into sensitive accounts on public Wi-Fi; use mobile data or a secure network instead.
- Regularly update your phone and apps to stay protected from security threats.
- Limit sharing personal information (phone number, address, college details) on social media.

Financial / UPI Safety Tips:

- Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details with anyone, even if they claim to be from a bank or service provider.

- Do not accept unknown payment requests or scan QR codes to “receive” money—this can result in money being deducted.
- Always log out after using accounts on shared or public devices.
- Stay alert to urgent messages asking for money or personal details—they are often scams.

Reporting Cybercrime:
If you experience any cyber fraud, report it immediately on the **National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)** or call the **Helpline 1930** for quick support and action.